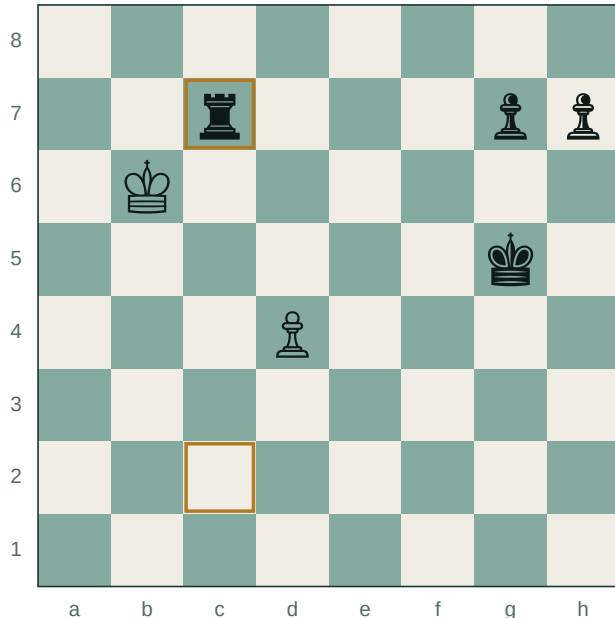


Promotion combinations: White, move 44

Promotion combinations

White to move



Previous move: 43...Rxc7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

44. Kxc7 Kf4 45. d5 g5 46. d6 g4 47. d7 g3 48. d8=Q

44.Kxc7 The king captures the rook on c7. Recorded reply: **44...Kf4**.

45.d5 The pawn moves from d4 to d5. Recorded reply: **45...g5**.

46.d6 The pawn moves from d5 to d6. Recorded reply: **46...g4**.

47.d7 The pawn moves from d6 to d7. Recorded reply: **47...g3**.

48.d8=Q The pawn moves from d7 to d8. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 2 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +13. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +13**: the balance goes from -6 to +7. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

HOW TO LOOK

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on g5. Geometrically undefended: rook on c7. Check for tactical protection.